

AJAY KAKADE



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📍 Pune

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Skills

- Business Development Strategy
- Revenue Growth & Ownership
- Sales Leadership & Team Management
- Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy
- Goal-International Market Expansion (US, EMEA, & APAC)
- Strategic Partnerships & Channel Development
- Enterprise, Mid-Market, Start-Up Sales
- Account-Based Marketing (ABM)
- Key Account Management
- C-Level Stakeholder Engagement
- Sales Process Design & Optimization

Languages

- English
- Marathi
- Hindi

Profile

• Experienced Business Development

Professional: 9+ years of experience in B2B sales, demand generation, Account-Based Marketing (ABM), lead generation, LinkedIn outreach, email marketing, market research, and account management within IT services and technology sectors.

• **Target-Driven Sales Performer:** Consistently achieved and exceeded revenue, pipeline, and lead generation targets through structured prospecting, qualification, and disciplined follow-up strategies.

• Strong Communication & Stakeholder

Engagement: Proven ability to engage C-level executives and decision-makers, conduct discovery conversations, build long-term client relationships, and drive successful deal closures.

• **CRM & Sales Automation Expertise:** Proficient in HubSpot, Salesforce, Zoho, Apollo, Outreach, Lemlist, and other sales engagement tools with strong pipeline management, forecasting, reporting, and CRM hygiene practices.

• **Full-Cycle Sales Management:** Hands-on experience managing the complete sales lifecycle from lead identification and qualification to proposal development, negotiation, closing, and post-sales coordination.

• **Market Research & ICP Development:** Skilled in identifying Ideal Customer Profiles (ICP), conducting competitive analysis, and executing data-driven outreach strategies to improve conversion rates.

• **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Experienced in working closely with marketing, pre-sales, solutions, and delivery teams to align messaging, improve lead quality, and accelerate deal progression.

• **Team Leadership & Mentorship:** Demonstrated ability to lead, mentor, and scale business development teams while defining KPIs, sales processes, and performance metrics to drive consistent growth.

Education

Bachelor of Engineering (Electronics)

Savitribai Phule Pune University
2011 – 2016 | Pune, India

Higher Secondary

Amrita Junior College of Science
2009 – 2011 | Pune, India

Secondary School

St. Jude High School
2008 – 2009 | Pune, India

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

• CRM & Sales Tools Proficiency:

Hands-on experience with HubSpot, Salesforce.com, Zoho CRM, LeadSquared, SalesHandy, Reply.io, Apollo.io, Mailchimp, Clearbit, SendinBlue, Outlook, and Google Workspace for pipeline management, automation, reporting, and lead nurturing. Experienced with freelance and marketplace platforms such as Upwork, Guru, and Fiverr for client acquisition.

• Digital Marketing Certification:

Completed Digital Marketing program from Lavenir Institute of Professional Studies (L.I.P.S.), Pune; Google Ads Fundamentals Certified (2017).

• Digital Marketing & ABM

Expertise: Strong knowledge of SEO, Social Media Marketing (SMM), Account-Based Marketing (ABM), paid campaigns, and data-driven lead generation strategies.

• **Industry Exposure:** Attended E-Tailing seminar at MITSOM, gaining insights into e-commerce trends, digital customer acquisition, and online sales strategies.

Professional Experience

Softenger

Inside Sales - Executive

Jul 2024 – Present | Pune, India

- Driving new business development in the US region for IT Services and Managed Services offerings.
- Leading MSP partnership initiatives, engaging small and mid-sized MSPs for delivery and white-label collaboration.
- Owning the full sales lifecycle including prospecting, discovery, solution discussions, proposal coordination, and commercial alignment.
- Conducting pre-sales discovery calls to understand infrastructure, security, compliance, and operational requirements.
- Positioning solutions across IT Infrastructure, Cloud, Cybersecurity, NOC/SOC, Application Support, and Offshore Delivery.
- Building a qualified US pipeline using LinkedIn Sales Navigator, Apollo, outbound email, and CRM tools.
- Engaging with CIOs, IT Directors, MSP Owners, and Founders across Healthcare, Telecom, SaaS, and Enterprise IT.
- Supporting post-sales handover and account growth, ensuring smooth onboarding and long-term relationship building.

Sales Consultant

Freelancer

Aug 2023 – Jun 2024 | Pune, India

- Nurtured end-to-end sales and marketing functions, devising strategic plans and executing comprehensive campaigns, resulting in a 25% increase in lead generation.
- Mentored a team of four professionals, fostering a collaborative work environment and improving team productivity.
- Actively engaged in client acquisition through direct sales calls, negotiations, and crafting tailored proposals, achieving a 40% client conversion rate.
- Led social media management initiatives, enhancing online presence and brand awareness, leading to a 50% increase in follower engagement.
- Conducted in-depth requirement gathering sessions with clients, ensuring accurate service delivery and a 95% client satisfaction rate.

- **Performance Recognition:**

Recognized multiple times for consistent overachievement, target attainment, and high sales performance.

- **Sales & Online Prospecting**

Expertise: Advanced proficiency in LinkedIn and LinkedIn Sales Navigator, social media marketing, customer acquisition, prospecting, and client relationship management. Strong working knowledge of MS Office tools.

- **Strategic & Analytical Skills:**

Experienced in SWOT analysis, project management, sales planning, and scenario-based strategy development to support revenue growth and business expansion.

- Strategized and executed market research initiatives, staying abreast of industry trends and informing strategic business decisions.
- Implemented metric tracking mechanisms to measure campaign effectiveness and sales performance, enabling data-driven decision-making.
- Contributed to a positive work culture aligned with client values and growth objectives, enhancing overall team morale and performance.

Recrosoft Technology

Senior Sales Development Representative

Oct 2022 – Jul 2023 | Bangalore, India

- Identified and researched potential clients, conducting outbound prospecting through email, social media, and cold calling, which improved conversion rates.
- Contributed to revenue generation by securing high-potential leads and facilitating their progression through the sales pipeline, driving new business opportunities.
- Engaged in consultative conversations with prospects to gain insights into their hiring needs and organizational goals, effectively tailoring solutions to meet those needs.
- Nurtured leads through personalized communications, guiding prospects through the sales funnel and enhancing lead engagement.
- Coordinated and facilitated introductory meetings between prospects and account managers, ensuring seamless communication and a smooth transition, resulting in better meeting attendance.
- Maintained and updated accurate prospect information in the CRM system, enhancing pipeline management efficiency and data accuracy.
- Tracked and analyzed key sales metrics, identifying areas for improvement and optimizing sales strategies, leading to increased overall sales efficiency.
- Collaborated with the marketing team to provide valuable feedback on lead generation campaigns and develop targeted messaging, improving campaign effectiveness.
- Developed and implemented onboarding procedures that improved client satisfaction and retention, resulting in a smoother client experience and stronger long-term relationships.

Adroit Resources

Senior Business Development

Apr 2021 – Sep 2022 | USA, Remote

- Managed and executed email campaigns based on business priorities, demand estimates, and internal stakeholder expectations, resulting in improved outreach efficiency and lead engagement.
- Created and implemented email drip campaigns, A/B testing, list building, and content generation, which enhanced lead conversion rates.
- Utilized platforms like LinkedIn Sales Navigator, Built-in, and Glassdoor to extract data on companies and hiring managers, improving the accuracy and relevance of targeted outreach.
- Maintained a comprehensive prospect database for lead generation purposes, ensuring data integrity and facilitating seamless lead tracking.
- Leveraged automation software such as Reply.io, SalesHandy, Thunderbird, and Apollo to distribute emails, significantly increasing outreach capacity and efficiency.
- Qualified and closed opportunities based on their size and complexity, contributing to the overall revenue growth of the company.
- Communicated and built professional relationships with existing clients and prospects, ensuring clear and effective delivery of marketing messages and fostering long-term partnerships.
- Analyzed campaign performance and provided actionable suggestions for improvements, leading to enhanced campaign effectiveness and ROI.
- Passed leads to appropriate team members with clear calls-to-action ensuring smooth handoffs and improved lead conversion.
- Continuously explored new ways to enhance programs by incorporating new technology, tools, trends, and best practices, driving innovation and competitive advantage.
- Recognized as a Performer of the Month for the following months: July 2021, October 2021, April 2022, and June 2022.

Talkd Inc.

Team Lead - Business Development

Mar 2019 – Sep 2020 | Pune, India

- Develop documentation and roadmaps for various processes, conduct A/B tests for campaigns, and oversee end-to-end execution of campaigns using email, LinkedIn, and social media for clients.

- Identify, evaluate, and implement tools and strategies to optimize sales and marketing processes, enhancing overall efficiency.
- Define key performance indicators (KPIs) for email marketing and establish strategies and processes for lead generation initiatives.
- Conduct thorough market research and SWOT analysis to align strategies with client goals successfully.
- Manage weekly, monthly, and quarterly email marketing performance, reporting, and consistently explore opportunities for optimization and improvement.
- Create and execute A/B testing projects to enhance email open rates, click-through rates, and conversions effectively.
- Lead a team in executing lead generation projects for assigned territories, surpassing monthly targets by three times over a one-year period.
- Generate marketing qualified leads (MQLs), opportunity leads, and schedule initial appointments through persuasive email campaigns.
- Successfully delivered over 24 projects, consistently exceeding set targets.
- Trained and mentored a team of 12 members, ensuring accountability and high-performance standards in project delivery.
- Develop and implement training programs to enhance the skills and knowledge of the business development team.
- Manage end-to-end client interactions, cultivating strong internal and external professional relationships, and ensuring overall client satisfaction.

BroadNet Technologies

Business Development Executive

Oct 2018 – Jan 2019 | Pune, India

- Took charge of managing email marketing campaigns to attract a broader range of leads and significantly expand business reach.
- Conducted thorough research on various bulk SMS services, establishing connections with potential clients through platforms like LinkedIn and Skype.
- Improved audience targeting by implementing advanced segmentation strategies, ensuring messages reached the right demographics effectively.

- Actively pursued and developed new business opportunities using a combination of cold calling, SMS marketing, and targeted email campaigns.
- Ensured strict adherence to industry regulations and best practices in all email marketing initiatives to maintain credibility and effectiveness.
- Leveraged CRM systems proficiently to streamline lead management processes and enhance customer relationships, thereby optimizing operational efficiency and increasing client satisfaction levels.

Upwork

Lead Generation & Database

Jun 2018 – Oct 2018 | Pune, India

Lead Generation/Data Entry/Email Handling/
Campaign Management/and Marketing:

- Implemented strategies for new business opportunities through effective data mining.
- Utilized online platforms and databases for targeted client identification and outreach.
- Verified and updated records for improved data integrity.
- Managed emails for timely communication and executed successful marketing campaigns.
- Tracked KPIs, optimizing strategies for efficient campaign performance.
- Proficiently used email marketing platforms for effective engagement.

https://www.upwork.com/freelancers/~01366adeaa0f62e8b7?mp_source=share

Omni-Bridge Systems

Business Development Executive

Sep 2017 – Jun 2018

- Managed lead generation activities, including overseeing email campaigns, appointment setting, and fixing appointments.
- Utilized platforms like LinkedIn, Clutch, and other sources to generate databases of potential clients.
- Proactively conducted prospecting activities to identify and cultivate warm leads.
- Effectively understood client requirements for mobile app development and promptly forwarded leads and warm responses to the sales team.
- Maintained and updated the sales pipeline, ensuring accurate and timely information.

- Implemented social media marketing strategies, specifically focusing on LinkedIn, to generate interest and engagement.
- Maintained detailed prospect and customer account lists for effective follow-up and relationship management.
- Developed a strong understanding of target sectors and successfully secured meetings with prospective clients through email and LinkedIn.
- Submitted regular progress reports and consistently worked towards achieving targets, with the opportunity to earn commissions.
- Ensured accurate data entry and management within the CRM system for efficient tracking and analysis.

Eptabiz Worldwide

Business Development Executive

Jun 2016 – Feb 2017 | Pune, India

- Developed and expanded a strong professional network, consistently generating new business referrals and supporting revenue growth.
- Engaged in meaningful conversations with prospects to understand their business needs and propose tailored solutions, resulting in improved conversion rates.
- Cultivated leads effectively, converting a higher number into validated prospects through targeted follow-ups and personalized engagement.
- Improved sales conversion rates by efficiently managing and conducting appointments via proactive outreach strategies.
- Executed extensive product promotions through innovative email campaigns and strategic cold calling, enhancing product visibility and market reach.
- Represented the company at local trade shows, establishing valuable connections and expanding brand presence in targeted regions.